

Practical Instructions on the Dhāraṇī of Vasudhārā

Vasudhāraṇi Upadeśa · Toh 3240 · Derge Tengyur

ནའོ་རྒྱ་མའ་གི་ཟུས་ཀྱི་ན་ངག་

Toh 3240 in the Tengyur is a practical instructional text known in Sanskrit as the Vasudhāraṇī Upadeśa and in Tibetan as Norgyünmé Zungki Mennag, meaning "The Practical Instructions on the Dhāraṇī of Vasudhārā." The text concerns the ritual application of the dhāraṇī of Vasudhārā, a Buddhist goddess associated with wealth and abundance, providing step-by-step guidance on how to perform her invocation before a thangka or image, construct a sandalwood maṇḍala, make offerings, and recite her dhāraṇī with the proper mental cultivation and intention. It belongs to the category of tantric or ritual instructional literature — upadeśa — offering practical guidance for practitioners seeking to accomplish specific aims through devotion to Vasudhārā. As part of the Tengyur, it represents a translated Indian treatise transmitted into Tibetan, rendered by the monk Tsültrim Gyeltsen.

Translated from the Indian language, the title is: Vasu-dhāraṇī Upadeśa. In Tibetan: The Practical Instructions on the Dhāraṇī of Vasudhārā.

Before a thangka of Vasudhārā or an image of her, one makes a square sandalwood maṇḍala. Into that maṇḍala one invites the Blessed Lady to be present in mind, and makes offerings to her. Then, with hands anointed with sandalwood, one takes up the book of the Vasudhārā dhāraṇī and places before it a water vessel into which has been placed a garland of flowers well-strung together with thread. With one's mind, one meditates correctly with great loving-kindness upon all sentient beings, and, with the aim of accomplishing one's desired purpose held clearly in one's heart, one recites the Vasudhārā dhāraṇī.

After reciting, each mantra is to be concluded by adding the syllable svāhā at its close. Then, together with white flowers including roots of dūrvā grass and unbroken grains, these are placed into the water vessel, and this continues for the duration of up to six months. After the recitation is complete, that water is to be poured out onto a clean patch of ground.

Here ends the Practical Instructions on the Dhāranī of Vasudhārā.

This was translated from the presence of the Bodhisattva Dā by the fully ordained monk Tsultrim Gyaltzen.

Translator's Notes

- The colophon names the translator as the fully ordained monk Tsultrim Gyaltzen, working from the teachings of a figure called "Bodhisattva Dā" — likely a transcription or abbreviation of an Indian master's name that cannot be fully recovered from this witness. The term "dūrvā" refers to a specific sacred grass (*Cynodon dactylon*) used in Indian ritual contexts; it has been left in Sanskrit as the most precise rendering. The instruction that mantras should be concluded with svāhā means the word svāhā, already present in standard dhāraṇī recitation, is to be voiced close to each mantra's end — this is a standard liturgical direction, not a modification of the mantra text itself.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.